MASTERFUNCTIONALSKILLS

★ OFQUAL REGULATED STANDARDS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS FOUNDATIONS — Entry Level 3 Core

Entry Level 3 Revision Cards

Core Maths • English • Digital Foundations

- ★ Column Addition, Subtraction, Division & Fractions
- ★ 24-Hour Time, Money, Metric Units & Scales
- ★ Reading Purpose, Email Layout, SPaG & SLC
- ★ Device Settings, Shortcuts, Spreadsheets & Safety

A6 Postcard Cardstock (148 × 105 mm)

Turn over for Deck Contents & Checklist ➔

masterfunctionalskills.co.uk

1. Place Value up to 1,000

NUMBER SYSTEM

Hundreds • Tens • Ones (H-T-O)

Every digit in a 3-digit number has a value based on its column: Hundreds (×100), Tens (×10), and Ones (×1). Zero (0) holds an empty column in place.

PLACE VALUE CHART (NUMBER: 749)

HUNDREDS	TENS	ONES
7	4	9
= 700	= 40	= 9

★ Golden Rule: Read 3-digit numbers from left to right: 407 is Four hundred and seven!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never drop the middle zero: 'Six hundred and five' is 605, NOT 65!

DfE E3.N1 • Entry Level 3

Turn over for Practice Challenge ➔

A6 Pocket Card

2. Column Addition & Subtraction

NUMBER SYSTEM

Align Right • Start at Ones • Regroup

Always line up Hundreds, Tens, and Ones on the right. Start at the Ones column. In addition, carry 10 to the next column; in subtraction, borrow from the left if the top digit is smaller.

ADDITION (CARRYING)

```
  3 6 7
+ 1 5 8
-------
  5 2 5
```

Carry: 1 hundred, 1 ten

SUBTRACTION (BORROW)

```
  5 4 2
- 2 1 7
-------
  3 2 5
```

4 tens → 3 tens, 12 - 7 = 5

★ Golden Rule: Always start adding or subtracting from the ONES column on the far right!

⚠️ Watch Out: In 342 - 158, do NOT do 8 - 2 = 6! You must borrow 1 ten from the 4 so 12 - 8 = 4.

DfE E3.N2 • Entry Level 3

Turn over for Practice Challenge ➔

A6 Pocket Card

3. Multiplying 2-Digit Numbers

NUMBER SYSTEM

Partition into Tens & Ones (Grid Method)

To multiply a 2-digit number by a single digit (e.g. 24 × 6), split 24 into 20 and 4. Multiply each part by 6 (20×6 = 120, 4×6 = 24), then add the answers together.

GRID METHOD: 24 × 6 = 144

×	20	4
6	120	24

120 + 24

= 144

★ Golden Rule: When multiplying by 10, move digits one place left and place a 0 at the end!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't forget the zero when multiplying the Tens part: 30 × 4 = 120, NOT 12!

DfE E3.N3 • Entry Level 3

Turn over for Practice Challenge ➔

A6 Pocket Card

Challenge: Place Value up to 1,000

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N1

What is the value of the digit 8 in the number 842, and how do you write 'seven hundred and nine' in digits?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Value of 8 = 800 (8 hundreds). 'Seven hundred and nine' = 709.

📋 DECK CONTENTS & REVISION CHECKLIST

30 Revision Cards

Tick [✓] Read when you understand the rule, and [★] Solved when you answer the challenge! Pearson & C&G Aligned

1. Place Value up to 1,000 (DfE E3.N1)
2. Column Addition & Subtraction (DfE E3.N2)
3. Multiplying 2-Digit Numbers (DfE E3.N3)
4. Division & Interpreting Remainders (DfE E3.N4)
5. Rounding to Nearest 10 & 100 (DfE E3.N5)
6. Fractions: Thirds, Quarters, Fifths & Tenths (DfE E3.N7)
7. Decimals up to 2 Decimal Places (DfE E3.N8)
8. Money: Pounds, Pence & Change (DfE E3.M10)
9. Time: Roman Numerals, 12-Hour & 24-Hour (DfE E3.M12)
10. Metric Units: Length, Weight & Capacity (DfE E3.M14)
11. Reading Scales & Dials (DfE E3.M18)
12. 2D & 3D Shapes, Right Angles & Symmetry (DfE E3.M19)
13. Compass Directions & Turns (DfE E3.M20)
14. Bar Charts, Pictograms & Tally Tables (DfE E3.HD21)
15. Main Purpose of a Text (DfE E3.R8)
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17. Using a Dictionary & Alphabetical Order (DfE E3.R10)
18. Writing Emails & Short Notes (DfE E3.W18)
19. Paragraphs & Sequencing Ideas (DfE E3.W19)
20. Sentence Punctuation & Capital Letters (DfE E3.W13)
21. Commas in Lists & Apostrophes (DfE E3.W14)
22. Subject-Verb Agreement (Was/Were & Is/Are) (DfE E3.W15)
23. Plurals (-s, -es, -ies) & Common Spellings (DfE E3.W17)
24. SLC E3: Listening, Questions & Turns (DfE E3.SLC1)
25. Device Settings, Wi-Fi & Accessibility (DFSQ E3.1)
26. Files, Folders & Keyboard Shortcuts (DFSQ E3.2)
27. Word Processing & Formatting Documents (DFSQ E3.6)
28. Simple Spreadsheets & Totals (=SUM) (DFSQ E3.8)
29. Email Attachments, Reply vs Reply All (DFSQ E3.10)
30. Online Safety: Passwords & Scams (DFSQ E3.12)

💡 **Tutor Golden Tip (Abdul):** Do not flip the card immediately! Attempt the Quick Challenge on the back using a dry-wipe pen or scratchpad first. Verify with the step-by-step model steps only after completing your working.

Challenge: Multiplying 2-Digit Numbers

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N3

A crate holds 36 bottles of water. How many bottles are in 4 crates?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Partition 36 into 30 + 6. (30 × 4 = 120) + (6 × 4 = 24) = 144 bottles.

Challenge: Column Addition & Subtraction

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N2

Calculate: (a) 468 + 275 (b) 604 - 238

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

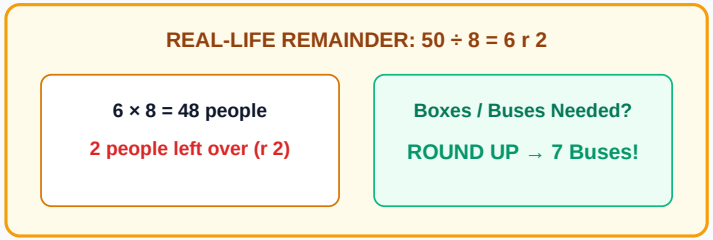
(a) 468 + 275 = 743 (carry 1 ten and 1 hundred). (b) 604 - 238 = 366.

4. Division & Interpreting Remainders

NUMBER SYSTEM

Bus Stop Division • Round Up or Down in Context

Divide from left to right. Any leftover amount is the remainder (r). In real-life problems, decide whether to round UP (e.g. minibuses/boxes needed) or round DOWN (what you can afford).



★ Golden Rule: Round UP when booking seats or buying tins so nothing is left short!

⚠ Watch Out: If asked for 'full packs', ignore remainder and round DOWN.

5. Rounding to Nearest 10 & 100

NUMBER SYSTEM

5 or More Rounds Up • 4 or Less Stays Same

To round to the nearest 10, look at the Ones digit. To round to the nearest 100, look at the Tens digit. If that neighbour digit is 5, 6, 7, 8, or 9, round UP; if 0–4, stay the same.



★ Golden Rule: Use rounded numbers to ESTIMATE and check if your calculator answer is sensible!

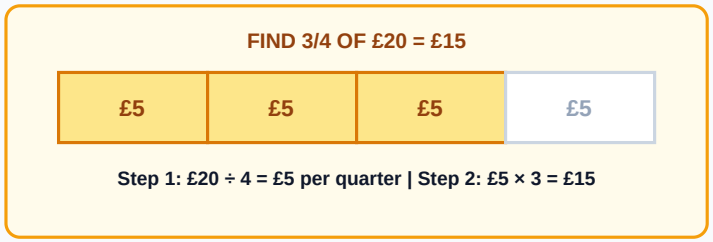
⚠ Watch Out: When rounding 674 to the nearest 100, look at the Tens digit (7), NOT the Ones digit (4)!

6. Fractions: Thirds, Quarters, Fifths & Tenths

NUMBER SYSTEM

Divide by the Bottom • Multiply by the Top

A fraction splits a whole into equal parts. To find a fraction of an amount (e.g. 3/4 of £20): Step 1: Divide the amount by the bottom number (20 ÷ 4 = 5). Step 2: Multiply by the top number (5 × 3 = £15).



★ Golden Rule: Divide by the bottom (denominator), then times by the top (numerator)!

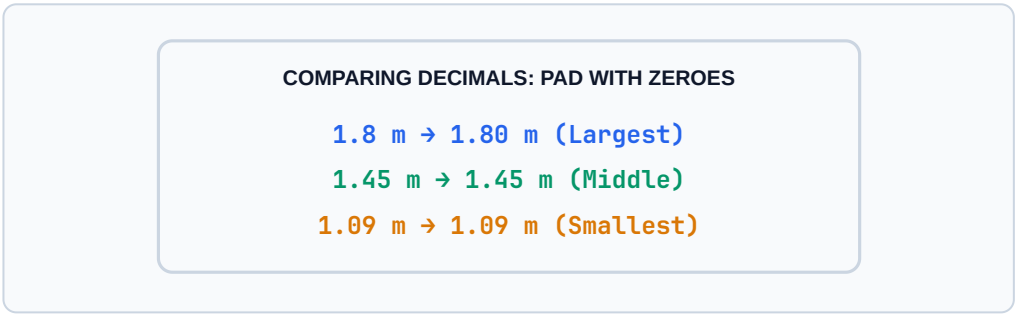
⚠ Watch Out: 1/3 is BIGGER than 1/5 — a smaller bottom number means larger slices!

7. Decimals up to 2 Decimal Places

NUMBER SYSTEM

Line Up the Decimal Points Vertically

Decimals show tenths (0.1) and hundredths (0.01), just like pounds and pence (£3.45). When adding or subtracting decimals, always line up the decimal points in a straight vertical column.



★ Golden Rule: Add a trailing zero (0.5 = 0.50) so both numbers have 2 decimals!

⚠ Watch Out: 0.4 is larger than 0.25 because 0.40 has 4 tenths while 0.25 has 2.

Challenge: Rounding to Nearest 10 & 100

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N5

Round 463: (a) to the nearest 10, and (b) to the nearest 100.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

(a) Nearest 10: Ones digit is 3 (< 5) → 460. (b) Nearest 100: Tens digit is 6 (≥ 5) → 500.

Challenge: Division & Interpreting Remainders

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N4

50 care home residents are going on a trip. Each minibus holds 8 people. How many minibuses are needed?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

50 ÷ 8 = 6 remainder 2. Because 2 people cannot be left behind, round UP to 7 minibuses.

Challenge: Decimals up to 2 Decimal Places

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N8

Put these lengths in order from shortest to longest: 1.45 m, 1.8 m, 1.09 m.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Write with 2 decimal places: 1.45 m, 1.80 m, 1.09 m. Order: 1.09 m, 1.45 m, 1.8 m.

Challenge: Fractions: Thirds, Quarters, Fifths & Tenths

NUMBER SYSTEM

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.N7

A jacket costs £45. It is reduced by 1/5 in a sale. How much money is taken off?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

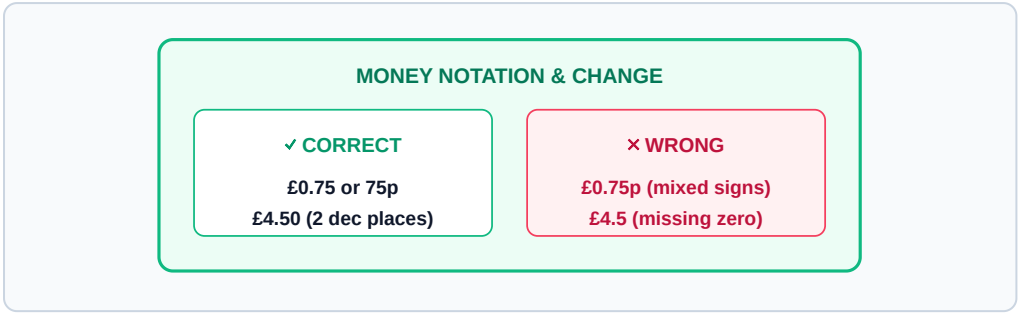
1/5 of £45 = 45 ÷ 5 = £9 taken off.

8. Money: Pounds, Pence & Change

MEASURES & MONEY

£1 = 100p • Never Mix £ and p Signs

Convert pence to pounds by dividing by 100 (e.g. 245p = £2.45). Write money with either a £ sign and 2 decimal places (£0.65) OR a p sign (65p), never both (£0.65p is wrong).



⋆ Golden Rule: Always write two digits after the dot for pounds: £4.5 on a calculator must be written as £4.50!

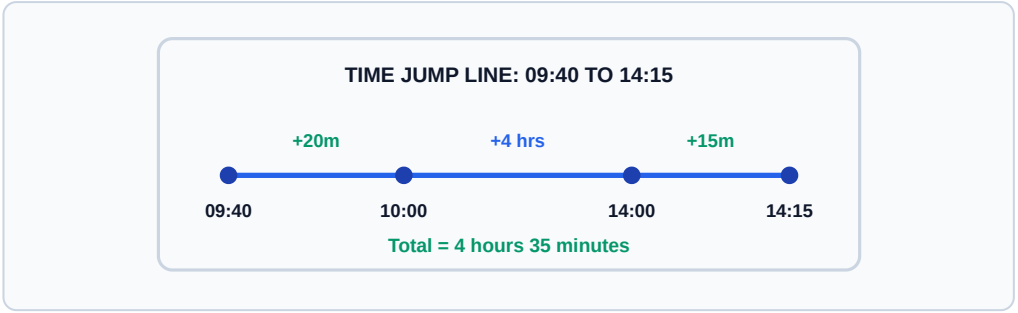
⚠ Watch Out: Before adding 85p and £2.40, convert 85p into £0.85 so both are in pounds!

9. Time: Roman Numerals, 12-Hour & 24-Hour

MEASURES & MONEY

Add 12 to PM Hours • 1 Hour = 60 Minutes

On clock faces: IV = 4, VI = 6, IX = 9, XII = 12. For 24-hour time, add 12 to afternoon (pm) hours from 1:00 pm onwards (e.g. 3:15 pm → 15:15). Count time intervals across the top of the hour (:00).



⋆ Golden Rule: There are 60 minutes in 1 hour — never use column subtraction as if 1 hour had 100 minutes!

⚠ Watch Out: 12:30 pm stays 12:30 in 24-hour time; 12:30 am (midnight) becomes 00:30.

10. Metric Units: Length, Weight & Capacity

MEASURES & MONEY

1 m = 100 cm • 1 kg = 1,000 g • 1 L = 1,000 ml

Length: 1 cm = 10 mm, 1 m = 100 cm, 1 km = 1,000 m. Weight: 1 kg = 1,000 g. Capacity: 1 Litre = 1,000 ml. Always convert to the SAME unit before adding or comparing.



⋆ Golden Rule: 'Kilo' (km, kg) and 'Milli' (ml, mm in a m) mean 1,000; 'Centi' (cm) means 100!

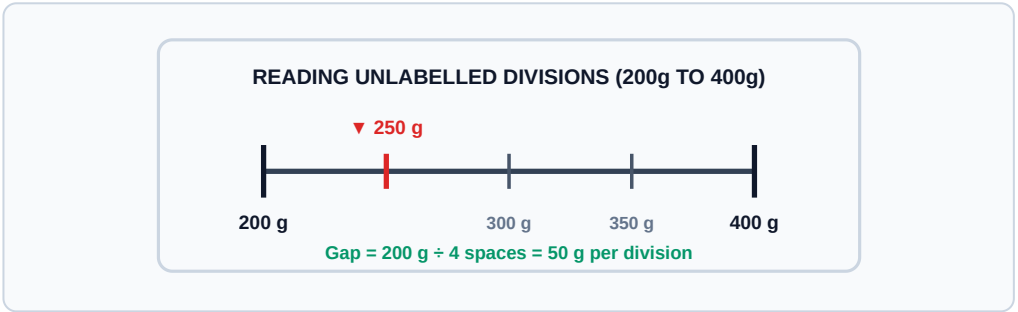
⚠ Watch Out: 1 metre is 100 cm (NOT 1,000 cm!). Half a kilogram (0.5 kg) is 500 g.

11. Reading Scales & Dials

MEASURES & MONEY

Find the Gap Divided by the Number of Steps

To read an unlabelled tick mark on a scale, thermometer, or weighing dial: (1) Subtract two neighbouring numbered marks to find the gap, then (2) Divide by the number of spaces between them.



⋆ Golden Rule: Count the SPACES (jumps) between numbered marks, not the lines!

⚠ Watch Out: If there are 5 spaces between 0 g and 100 g, each mark is 100 ÷ 5 = 20 g (not 10 g!).

Challenge: Time: Roman Numerals, 12-Hour & 24-Hour

MEASURES & MONEY

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M12

A shift starts at 9:40 am and finishes at 2:15 pm (14:15). How long is the shift in hours and minutes?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

9:40 am to 10:00 am = 20 mins. 10:00 am to 2:00 pm = 4 hours. 2:00 pm to 2:15 pm = 15 mins. Total = 4 hours 35 minutes.

Challenge: Money: Pounds, Pence & Change

MEASURES & MONEY

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M10

You buy a sandwich for £3.25 and a tea for 90p. How much change do you get from a £10 note?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

90p = £0.90. Total cost = £3.25 + £0.90 = £4.15. Change = £10.00 - £4.15 = £5.85.

Challenge: Reading Scales & Dials

MEASURES & MONEY

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M18

A kitchen scale has 4 equal spaces between 200 g and 400 g. The pointer is 1 mark past 200 g. What is the weight?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Gap = 400 - 200 = 200 g. Step size = 200 ÷ 4 = 50 g per mark. Weight = 200 + 50 = 250 g.

Challenge: Metric Units: Length, Weight & Capacity

MEASURES & MONEY

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M14

A jug holds 2 Litres of juice. You pour out three 250 ml glasses. How many millilitres (ml) are left in the jug?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

2 Litres = 2,000 ml. Poured out: 3 × 250 ml = 750 ml. Left: 2,000 - 750 = 1,250 ml (or 1.25 L).

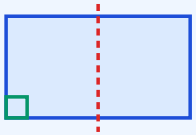
12. 2D & 3D Shapes, Right Angles & Symmetry

SHAPE & SPACE

Faces, Edges & Vertices • 90° Right Angles

A right angle (90°) is a square corner like a book edge. A line of symmetry folds a 2D shape into two matching halves. 3D shapes have flat/curved Faces, Edges, and Vertices (corners).

RIGHT ANGLE & SYMMETRY



4 Right Angles (90° corners)

3D SHAPE PROPERTIES

- **Cube/Cuboid: 6 Faces,** 12 Edges, 8 Vertices
- **Cylinder: 3 Faces (2 flat,** 1 curved), 2 Edges, 0 Vertices

★ **Golden Rule: A cuboid (box) has 6 rectangular faces, 12 edges, and 8 vertices (corners)!**

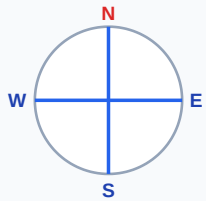
⚠️ **Watch Out: A rectangle has 2 lines of symmetry (vertical & horizontal), NOT 4 — folding diagonally does not match!**

13. Compass Directions & Turns

SHAPE & SPACE

Never Eat Shredded Wheat (N • E • S • W)

The 8 compass points go clockwise: North (N), North-East (NE), East (E), South-East (SE), South (S), South-West (SW), West (W), North-West (NW). A quarter turn is 1 right angle (90°).



8-POINT COMPASS & TURNS

- Quarter turn = 1 right angle (N → E)
- Half turn = Opposite way (N → S)
- Diagonal points: NE, SE, SW, NW

★ **Golden Rule: Clockwise follows clock hands; Anti-clockwise turns the opposite way!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Check the facing direction before calculating quarter or half turns.**

14. Bar Charts, Pictograms & Tally Tables

HANDLING DATA

Always Check the Pictogram Key First!

In a pictogram, one symbol often stands for 2, 4, or 10 items — always read the Key first! In a bar chart, read across from the top of the bar to the vertical frequency axis.

PICTOGRAM KEY RULE: 1 CIRCLE (●) = 4 ITEMS

Monday: ●●●◗ 4 + 4 + 4 + 2 = 14

Full symbol = 4 | Half symbol = 2 | Quarter symbol = 1

★ **Golden Rule: If 1 circle = 4 items, then half a circle = 2 items and a quarter circle = 1 item!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never count pictogram symbols as '1 each' without checking the Key box!**

15. Main Purpose of a Text

READING BASICS

To Inform • To Instruct • To Persuade

Every text has a main purpose: To Inform (gives facts, dates, or news), To Instruct (step-by-step recipes or safety rules using command verbs), or To Persuade (adverts encouraging you to buy or join).

INFORM	INSTRUCT	PERSUADE
Gives facts, times & details	Numbered steps & command verbs	Encourages you to buy, join, or act
Notice / Timetable	Recipe / Manual	Poster / Advert

★ **Golden Rule: When naming purpose, state both the verb AND topic (e.g. To warn about)!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never just write 'To inform' — write 'To inform staff about fire rules'.**

Challenge: Compass Directions & Turns

SHAPE & SPACE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M20

You are facing North. You turn a quarter-turn (90°) anti-clockwise. Which direction are you facing now?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Facing West (1 quarter-turn anti-clockwise from North).

Challenge: 2D & 3D Shapes, Right Angles & Symmetry

SHAPE & SPACE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.M19

How many faces, edges, and vertices does a cube have, and how many right angles are inside a rectangle?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Cube: 6 faces, 12 edges, 8 vertices. A rectangle has 4 right angles (90° corners).

Challenge: Main Purpose of a Text

READING BASICS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.R8

A leaflet titled '5 Easy Steps to Reset Your Work Password' uses numbered steps. What is its main purpose?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

To instruct (or explain to) staff how to reset their work password step by step.

Challenge: Bar Charts, Pictograms & Tally Tables

HANDLING DATA

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.HD21

In a pictogram, Key: 1 star = 4 books. Monday shows 3 full stars and a half star. How many books were borrowed on Monday?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

3 full stars = 3 × 4 = 12 books. Half star = 4 ÷ 2 = 2 books. Total = 12 + 2 = 14 books.

16. Organizational Features (Headings & Bullets)

READING BASICS

Headings, Subheadings, Bullet Points & Boxes

Writers use organizational features to help readers find information fast: Headings show the main topic, Subheadings divide sections, Bullet points list key facts, and Text boxes highlight warnings or prices.

LAYOUT FEATURES THAT HELP THE READER

- **Main Heading:** Grabs attention & states overall topic
- **Subheadings:** Split text into clear, easy-to-scan sections
- **Bullet Points / Numbered Lists:** Make key steps stand out
- **Bold Text & Captions:** Highlight important words & photos

★ **Golden Rule: Use subheadings like signposts to jump straight to the needed section!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Name the specific feature (e.g. Subheading, Table, Bullet points).**

17. Using a Dictionary & Alphabetical Order

READING BASICS

Compare the 1st, 2nd, then 3rd Letter

To put words in alphabetical (A–Z) order or look them up in a dictionary/index: compare the first letter. If the first letters are the same, compare the second letter (or third letter).

ALPHABETICAL ORDER: CHECK THE NEXT LETTER

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Compare: Paper • Postcode • Printer

Since A → O → R: Paper, then Postcode, then Printer!

★ **Golden Rule: Check the 3rd and 4th letters when words start with the same letters!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'Staff' comes before 'Store' because 'a' precedes 'o' in the alphabet.**

18. Writing Emails & Short Notes

EVERYDAY WRITING

To • Subject Line • Greeting • Paragraphs • Sign-Off

Every Entry 3 email needs: (1) A clear Subject Line, (2) A polite greeting ('Dear Mr Patel,' or 'Hi Sarah,'), (3) Short paragraphs answering every bullet point in the task, and (4) A polite sign-off ('Kind regards,').

✉️ **EMAIL CHECKLIST (ENTRY LEVEL 3)**

Subject: Shift Swap Request – Tuesday 14 May

Dear Manager,

I am writing to ask if I can swap my Tuesday morning shift...

Kind regards, Alex Carter

★ **Golden Rule: Tick off each task bullet point to ensure full content marks are won!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never leave the email Subject line blank — it costs an easy mark.**

19. Paragraphs & Sequencing Ideas

EVERYDAY WRITING

Start a New Paragraph for Each New Topic

Break your writing into at least 3 clear paragraphs: (1) Opening (why you are writing), (2) Middle (details and examples), and (3) Ending (what happens next). Use time linkers like First, Next, Then, Finally.

3-PARAGRAPH STRUCTURE + SEQUENCING WORDS

1. OPENING	2. DETAILS	3. ENDING
Why you are writing	First, Next, Also, Because	Finally, action & thank you

★ **Golden Rule: Leave a clear blank line between paragraphs to show structure clearly!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Writing one giant block of text without breaks loses layout marks.**

Challenge: Using a Dictionary & Alphabetical Order

READING BASICS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.R10

Put these four words in alphabetical order: Printer, Paper, Postcode, Folder.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Folder (F), 2. Paper (Pa), 3. Postcode (Po), 4. Printer (Pr).

Challenge: Organizational Features (Headings & Bullets)

READING BASICS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.R9

Why does a safety poster use bullet points instead of one long paragraph?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Bullet points break up the text so key safety rules are quick and easy to read at a glance.

Challenge: Paragraphs & Sequencing Ideas

EVERYDAY WRITING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W19

Give three sequencing words you can use to order instructions for a new colleague.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

First (or Firstly), Next (or Then / After that), and Finally.

Challenge: Writing Emails & Short Notes

EVERYDAY WRITING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W18

Write a clear Subject Line and Greeting for an email to your manager, Mrs Singh, requesting Friday off.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Subject: Annual Leave Request – Friday 18 October | Greeting: Dear Mrs Singh,

20. Sentence Punctuation & Capital Letters

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

M.I.N.T.S. Capitals • Full Stops • Question Marks

Start every sentence with a Capital Letter and end with a Full Stop (.), Question Mark (?), or Exclamation Mark (!). Always capitalise Months/Days, the word 'I', Names of people, and Places (Oxford, Tuesday).

M.I.N.T.S. CAPITAL LETTER CHECKLIST

- **M — Months & Days:** Friday, November
- **I — The word 'I':** I work at the clinic.
- **N — Names & Places:** Abdul, Oxford, High Street
- **S — Start of Every Sentence (+ end with . ? !)**

★ **Golden Rule: Every question must end with a question mark (?), not a full stop!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't join two complete sentences with a comma — use a full stop.**

21. Commas in Lists & Apostrophes

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

Commas Separate List Items • Apostrophes for Missing Letters

Use commas to separate items in a list ('We need pens, paper, folders and tape'). Use an apostrophe (') to show where letters are missing in contractions (don't = do not, can't = cannot, I'm = I am).

COMMAS IN A LIST

"Bring a pen, a notepad, your ID badge and water."

Separates 3 or more items

APOSTROPHE (OMISSION)

- do not → don't
- it is → it's
- you are → you're

★ **Golden Rule: Put the apostrophe in the exact spot where the missing letter was taken out!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never put an apostrophe in simple plural words: 'Three coffees and two cakes' has NO apostrophe!**

22. Subject-Verb Agreement (Was/Were & Is/Are)

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

Singular Takes 'Is/Was' • Plural Takes 'Are/Were'

Match the verb to the subject: One person/thing (I, he, she, it, the bus) takes 'is' or 'was'. More than one (we, they, the buses) and 'you' ALWAYS take 'are' or 'were' ('We were happy', NEVER 'We was').

SINGULAR (ONE)

- I was / He was / She was
- The train is / was late
- There is one seat left

PLURAL (2+ OR 'YOU')

- We were / They were
- You were (NEVER 'you was')
- There are many options

★ **Golden Rule: Always write 'We were', 'They were', and 'You were' (never 'We was')!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: 'There is' is for one item; 'There are' is for multiple items.**

23. Plurals (-s, -es, -ies) & Common Spellings

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

Ch/Sh/S/X Add -es • Consonant + Y Changes to -ies

Most nouns add -s for plurals. Words ending in -ch, -sh, -s, -x, or -z add -es (box → boxes, bus → buses). Words ending in a consonant + y drop the y and add -ies (baby → babies, city → cities).

THE 3 PLURAL SPELLING RULES

1. Ends in -s, -sh, -ch, -x → Add -ES: box → boxes, watch → watches
2. Consonant + Y → Drop Y, add -IES: city → cities, lorry → lorries
3. Vowel + Y → Keep Y, add -S: day → days, trolley → trolleys

★ **Golden Rule: Consonant + y becomes -ies (party → parties); vowel + y adds -s!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Irregular plurals change completely: child → children, person → people.**

Challenge: Commas in Lists & Apostrophes

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W14

Add commas and an apostrophe to fix this sentence: 'Weve packed sandwiches apples crisps and water.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

'We've packed sandwiches, apples, crisps and water.'

Challenge: Sentence Punctuation & Capital Letters

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W13

Fix the 4 errors in this sentence: 'on monday i am going to london, when does the train leave.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

'On Monday I am going to London. When does the train leave?' (Capitals for On, Monday, I, London + Full Stop + Question Mark).

Challenge: Plurals (-s, -es, -ies) & Common Spellings

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W17

Write the plural of these three words: (a) box (b) family (c) key

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

(a) boxes (add -es) (b) families (consonant + y → -ies) (c) keys (vowel + y → add -s).

Challenge: Subject-Verb Agreement (Was/Were & Is/Are)

SPAG FOUNDATIONS

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.W15

Choose the correct verbs: 'We (was / were) waiting at the stop because the buses (was / were) delayed.'

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

'We were waiting at the stop because the buses were delayed.'

24. SLC E3: Listening, Questions & Turns

SPEAKING & LISTENING

Listen Actively • Ask Relevant Questions • Take Turns

In your Entry 3 Speaking & Listening discussion: (1) Listen carefully without interrupting, (2) State your views clearly with a reason ('I think... because...'), and (3) Ask at least two relevant questions to others.

ENTRY 3 SPEAKING & LISTENING SUCCESS

- ✓ Speak Clearly: "I think we should... because..."
- ✓ Ask Questions: "What do you think is the best day for...?"
- ✓ Respect Turns: Nod, keep eye contact, and don't interrupt

⋆ Golden Rule: Always add 'because...' to explain your reasons during discussions!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't stay silent after speaking — invite others to share views.

25. Device Settings, Wi-Fi & Accessibility

USING DEVICES

Wi-Fi Padlock • Display Zoom • Volume & Contrast

Use your device Settings app to connect to secure Wi-Fi (look for the padlock icon), adjust screen brightness/text size for readability, and install system updates to fix security bugs.

ESSENTIAL DEVICE SETTINGS (ENTRY 3)

- 🔒 Secure Wi-Fi: Look for the padlock icon & enter password
- 🔍 Accessibility: Increase Text Size, Zoom, or High Contrast
- 🔄 Software Updates: Install updates to patch security risks

⋆ Golden Rule: Only connect to Wi-Fi networks that show a padlock icon and require a password!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never log into online banking on an open, unlocked public Wi-Fi network!

26. Files, Folders & Keyboard Shortcuts

USING DEVICES

Clear File Names • Ctrl+C (Copy) • Ctrl+V (Paste)

Save files into named folders with clear, descriptive filenames (e.g. 'CV_Alex_Carter.pdf', not 'doc1'). Essential shortcuts: Ctrl+C = Copy, Ctrl+X = Cut, Ctrl+V = Paste, Ctrl+Z = Undo, Ctrl+S = Save.

THE 4 GOLDEN KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Ctrl + C = COPY	Ctrl + V = PASTE
Ctrl + Z = UNDO	Ctrl + S = SAVE

⋆ Golden Rule: Press Ctrl + Z immediately if you make a mistake to undo your action!

⚠️ Watch Out: Know file extensions: .docx = Word, .pdf = Print, .png = Image.

27. Word Processing & Formatting Documents

CREATING & EDITING

Bold (B) • Centre Align • Bullet Lists • Spellcheck

In a poster or notice: make the main title Larger (18–24pt), Bold (B), and Centre-aligned. Keep body text Left-aligned (11–12pt) so it is easy to read, and use Bullet Points for lists.

[B] Bold | [I] Italic | [U] Underline | [•] Bullets

STAFF FIRE SAFETY NOTICE (Bold, 18pt, Centred)

- Leave the building calmly via the nearest green exit sign.
- Report to Assembly Point B in the main car park.

(Body text: Left-aligned, 12pt, clean bullet points)

⋆ Golden Rule: Right-click red wavy underlines to correct spellings before saving!

⚠️ Watch Out: Keep body text left-aligned — never centre-align long paragraphs.

Challenge: Device Settings, Wi-Fi & Accessibility

USING DEVICES

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.1

A colleague finds the text on their tablet screen too small to read. Which device setting should they adjust?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Open Settings → Display / Accessibility → Increase Font Size (or Screen Zoom).

Challenge: SLC E3: Listening, Questions & Turns

SPEAKING & LISTENING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DfE E3.SLC1

Give one polite question you could ask a classmate during a discussion about local recycling.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

"How easy do you find it to use the recycling bins on your street?" (or "What could the council do to help people recycle more?").

Challenge: Word Processing & Formatting Documents

CREATING & EDITING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.6

How should you format the main heading of a workplace safety notice so it stands out clearly?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Make the heading Bold, increase the font size (e.g. 18–22pt), and Centre-align it at the top of the page.

Challenge: Files, Folders & Keyboard Shortcuts

USING DEVICES

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.2

Which keyboard shortcut copies selected text, and which shortcut pastes it into a new place?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Ctrl + C copies the selected text; Ctrl + V pastes it.

28. Simple Spreadsheets & Totals (=SUM)

CREATING & EDITING

Columns (A, B, C) • Rows (1, 2, 3) • Always Start with =

Each box in a spreadsheet is a cell named by its Column letter and Row number (e.g. B4). Every formula MUST start with an equals sign (=): use =B2+B3 or =SUM(B2:B5) to add numbers.

SPREADSHEET FORMULA SYMBOLS

```
=SUM(B2:B5) → Adds all cells from B2 down to B5
=B2-C2 → Subtracts C2 from B2
=B2*C2 → Multiplies B2 by C2 (* means ×)
=B2/C2 → Divides B2 by C2 (/ means ÷)
```

★ Golden Rule: Always begin spreadsheet formulas with '=' (e.g. =SUM(A1:A5))!

⚠️ Watch Out: Use '*' for multiply and '/' for divide — never type the letter 'x'.

29. Email Attachments, Reply vs Reply All

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Paperclip = Attach File • Check Recipient Before Sending

Click the Paperclip icon to attach a file (like a PDF or photo) to an email. Use 'Reply' to answer ONLY the sender; use 'Reply All' only when everyone on the thread needs to see your answer.

↩️ REPLY (ONE PERSON)

Sends your message ONLY to the person who emailed

✓ Safe for private info

📎 ATTACHMENTS

Click Paperclip icon (📎) to attach a PDF or photo

✓ Check file name & size

★ Golden Rule: Always attach the file before sending if writing 'please find attached'!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never click 'Reply All' when sending sensitive personal information.

30. Online Safety: Passwords & Scams

BEING SAFE & SECURE

3 Random Words + Symbols • Check HTTPS Padlock

Create strong passwords using three random words plus numbers/symbols (e.g. 'Green#kettle42!'). When shopping or banking online, check the browser address bar starts with 'https://' and has a padlock icon.

3 GOLDEN RULES FOR STAYING SAFE ONLINE

1. Strong Password: 3 random words + numbers/symbols + 2FA code
2. Safe Websites: Check for https:// and the Padlock icon in URL bar
3. Spot Phishing: Ignore urgent panic links & fake sender addresses

★ Golden Rule: Never click links in unexpected security alerts or parcel texts!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never use obvious passwords like 'password123' or your date of birth.

Challenge: Email Attachments, Reply vs Reply All

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.10

You receive a company-wide email from HR asking you to send your private bank details. Should you click 'Reply' or 'Reply All'?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Click 'Reply' (so only HR receives your private details, NOT the entire company).

Challenge: Simple Spreadsheets & Totals (=SUM)

CREATING & EDITING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.8

Write the spreadsheet formula to add the costs in cells B2, B3, B4, and B5.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=SUM(B2:B5) (or =B2+B3+B4+B5).

Challenge: Online Safety: Passwords & Scams

BEING SAFE & SECURE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFSQ E3.12

State two signs that a text message claiming 'Your parcel is held—click here to pay £1.99' is a phishing scam.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Urgent demand for payment via an unfamiliar web link. 2. Sent from an unknown mobile number with a generic greeting.